SportDrip — Permanent Engagement Additions

Scope: one-time, in-app changes that do not rotate. Based on a read of the current repo (functions/src, artifacts/mobile) and prior project decisions. Date: Nov 5, 2026.

Bottom line

SportDrip already implements nearly every mechanic that well-documented retention products use (table below). Most research-backed ideas are **already built**. Only five permanent gaps were found; anything not listed was either already present or lacked evidence.

Already implemented (no action)

Proven mechanic	Already in SportDrip (file)
Daily habit / streaks + freeze + repair	functions/src/lib/streak.ts
Daily reward	Free 100-credit daily bet, Prize Boxes, SpinWheel
Levels / XP / level rewards	lib/progression.ts, lib/xp.ts, levels.tsx
Achievements / trophies	constants/achievements.ts, TrophyArt
Weekly quests	callable/quests.ts
Season pass (engine + UI)	lib/seasonPass.ts, app/season.tsx
Competitive leagues w/ promotion/relegation	lib/ladder.ts (Bronze→Diamond)
Friend leagues, H2H, Pick'em, Survivor, Bracket	constants/leagueTypes.ts
Social: chat, reactions, taunts, tail/fade, feed	callable/social.ts, taunts.ts, CrewFeed
Co-op group goals (experiment)	lib/coop.ts
Recaps / shareables	lib/wrapped.ts, Tuesday League Report (lib/weekly.ts)
Timely push (lock reminders, sweat) with budget	scheduled/reminders.ts, lib/pushBudget.ts
Referral bonus	callable/referrals.ts
A/B testing framework	lib/experiments.ts
Healthy-play limits	lib/playLimits.ts

Gaps worth adding

1. Friend Streaks (paired streak). Evidence: Duolingo reports learners with at least one Friend Streak are 22% more likely to complete their daily lesson, rising with more friend streaks. Repo: no friend/shared streak found (searched friendStreak, sharedStreak, buddy). Fit: reuse lib/streak.ts day logic per friend pair; both must place a pick that ET day. Low risk.

2. Gifting cosmetics to friends. Evidence: Fortnite added item-shop gifting in 2018 (Engadget); measured retention impact was not published — treat as plausible, not proven. Repo: no gift/transfer callable. Fit: gift items only (not credits) to block alt-account credit farming; server-priced in one transaction like callable/shop.ts; require mutual friendship + minimum account age.

3. Time-window fields on store items. Repo: catalog only has a boolean *available* (callable/shop.ts:44). Add *availableFrom* / *availableUntil* / *featured* enforced server-side, plus a 'Featured / Leaving soon' Drip Shop section. Required infrastructure for the rotating plan (separate PDF).

4. Quest pool + weekly selection engine. Repo: QUESTS is a hardcoded list of 4 identical quests every week. Change to a Firestore-defined pool with deterministic weekly picks (weekKey + uid hash, same as lib/experiments.ts bucketing). Keeps the effort/social/skill structure.

5. Lapsed-player win-back flow. Repo: pushes are bet/game triggered; nothing targets users inactive N days. Add a scheduled job: day-3/7/14 inactivity → one engagement-class push (respects pushBudget) + a returning-player Prize Box on next open. Evidence is weaker: mostly vendor case studies (e.g. Battle Cats reported >1M lapsed players

returned) without isolated numbers.

Considered and rejected

Global leaderboards (ladder covers near-peer competition), more daily rewards (already 3 daily hooks; adding more dilutes value), parlays (already present), loot-box-style paid randomness (not justified; also regulatory risk for a betting-themed app).

Sources

Duolingo, 'Improving the streak' — blog.duolingo.com/improving-the-streak

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Wrexham.com, 'Fortnite and FOMO: how limited-time skins control player behavior' (2025) — wrexham.com/promo/fortnite-and-fomo-how-limited-time-skins-control-player-behavior-281577.html